

Skyla Trousdale
CART 498
Sep 23 2026

Gen AI Art Essay

Generally I am skeptical of the potential of generative AI in creative fields, and I think it takes immense skill to create appealing AI artwork. For every impressive AI artist, I believe there are hundreds who miss the mark with their work.

After looking at 15 Gen AI artists, I've noticed a nauseating movement quality in AI generated landscapes or human subjects, a mix of uncomfortable unnatural geometries and uncanny valley effects with overwhelming motion or glitches. While this is interesting in itself, the lack of any acknowledgement of this quality or aesthetic achievements decimates the appeal of these works.

However, I find abstracted static or fluid visual work with AI seems promising. For example, Refik Anadol's abstracted organic liquid maps of the neural nodes of AI itself serves as a meta dissection of the AI itself, functioning as a abstracted nude of the AI model. In the abstractions like this, the unappealing motion qualities of AI generated content are lost, preserving just the conceptual and aesthetic appeal of AI art

My favourite AI artist is Female Pentimento. Her work takes her own old iPhone footage, then uses AI techniques to overlay her photos and enhance the dream-like quality of each piece. This algorithmicly connection to the real preserves a surreal quality while feeling tangible and relatable. Further, the photos worship of a perverted divinity aligns well with the viscerally unsettling yet physically perfect quality of AI content.

